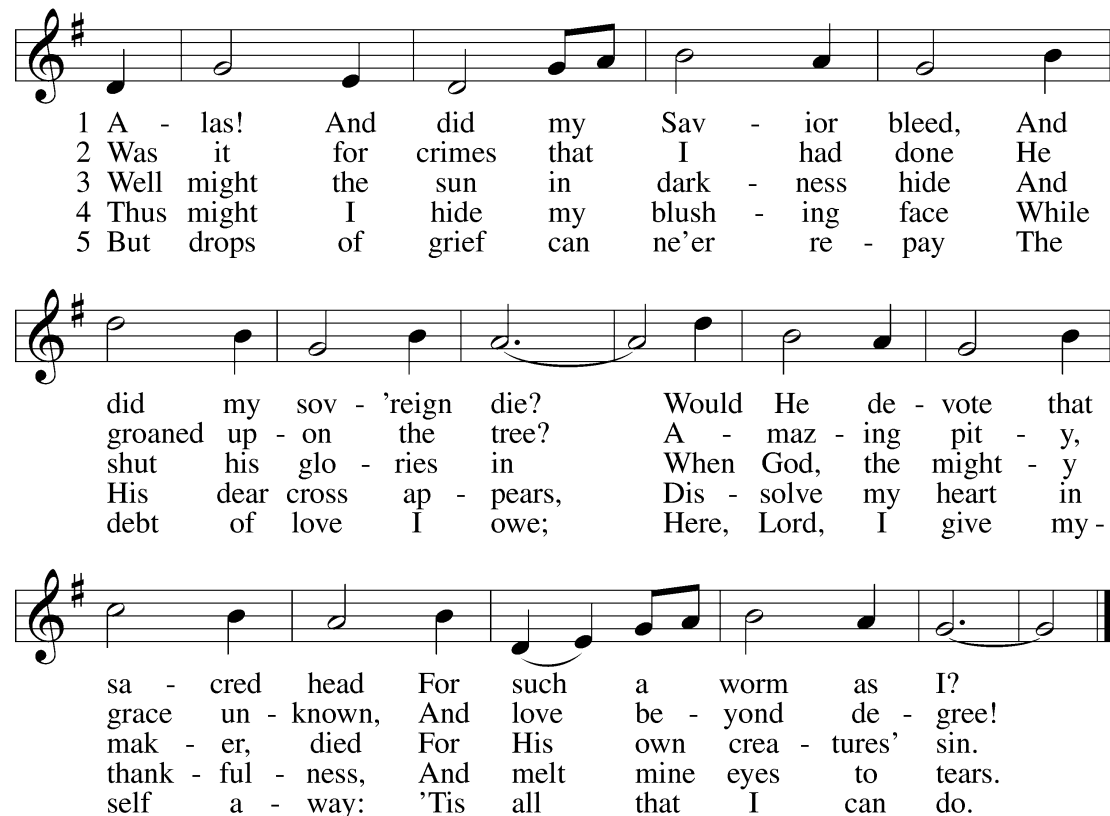


Lenten Worship Service
March 18, 2020
7:30 P.M.

Joy Comes in the Morning

Prelude

Opening Hymn ***“Alas! And Did My Savior Bleed” # 437***



1 A - las! And did my Sav - ior bleed, And
2 Was it for crimes that I had done He
3 Well might the sun in dark - ness hide And
4 Thus might I hide my blush - ing face While
5 But drops of grief can ne'er re - pay The

did my sov - 'reign die? Would He de - vote that
groaned up - on the tree? A - maz - ing pit - y,
shut his glo - ries in When God, the might - y
His dear cross ap - pears, Dis - solve my heart in
debt of love I owe; Here, Lord, I give my -

sa - cred head For such a worm as I?
grace un - known, And love be - yond de - gree!
mak - er, died For His own crea - tures' sin.
thank - ful - ness, And melt mine eyes to tears.
self a - way: 'Tis all that I can do.

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Invocation

- P** In the name of the Father and of the Son and of the Holy Spirit.
C **Amen.**

Confession and Absolution

- P** “Unless you people see miraculous signs and wonders,” said Jesus to the Galilean crowd, “you will never believe.” Too many times we want to “see” spectacular evidence of God’s working in our world before we affirm His love for us.
- C** **Lord, forgive us for our shallow faith.**
- P** We want God to work miracles in our lives to resolve our immediate problems, but we are reluctant to let Him work in our hearts.
- C** **Lord, forgive us for reducing You in our minds to that of a mere miracle-worker. Help us to rely upon you--totally--as our Savior and Lord in all areas of our lives.**
- P** Lord, we confess our sins to You.
- C** **Almighty God, by our very nature we are sinful and we gravitate towards the evil inclinations of our flesh. We have sinned against You through our thoughts, our words, and our actions. We do things that we shouldn’t and we neglect to do the things that we should. Busy schedules, relationships, and pressing projects too easily take precedence over our relationship to You. Forgive us, we pray, through Jesus Christ, our Lord, that our souls may be healed by Your never ending grace.**
- P** We are healed! We are forgiven! In the resurrection on the last day, our frail flesh shall join the soul in perfect healing. The Lord Jesus will transform our lowly bodies so that they will be like His glorious body. *Philippians 3:21*
- C** **We believe in the forgiveness of sins, the resurrection of the body, and the life everlasting.**
- P** As you believe, even so, may it be to you. Upon this, your confession, I declare to you the forgiveness of all your sins in the name of the Father and of the Son and of the Holy Spirit.
- C** **Amen.**

The Prayer of the Day

P The Lord be with you.

C And also with you.

P Let us pray: Gracious God, our heavenly Father, Your mercy attends us all our days. Be our strength and support amid the wearisome changes of this world, and at life's end grant us Your promised rest and the full joys of Your salvation; through Jesus Christ, Your Son, our Lord, who lives and reigns with You and the Holy Spirit, one God, now and forever.

C Amen.

SCRIPTURE READINGS

First Lesson

Psalms 59:14-17

They return at evening, snarling like dogs, and prowl about the city. [15] They wander about for food and howl if not satisfied. [16] But I will sing of your strength, in the morning I will sing of your love; for you are my fortress, my refuge in times of trouble. [17] You are my strength, I sing praise to you; you, God, are my fortress, my God on whom I can rely.

Second lesson

Acts 16:25-34

About midnight Paul and Silas were praying and singing hymns to God, and the other prisoners were listening to them. [26] Suddenly there was such a violent earthquake that the foundations of the prison were shaken. At once all the prison doors flew open, and everyone's chains came loose. [27] The jailer woke up, and when he saw the prison doors open, he drew his sword and was about to kill himself because he thought the prisoners had escaped. [28] But Paul shouted, "Don't harm yourself! We are all here!" [29] The jailer called for lights, rushed in and fell trembling before Paul and Silas. [30] He then brought them out and asked, "Sirs, what must I do to be saved?" [31] They replied, "Believe in the Lord Jesus, and you will be saved—you and your household." [32] Then they spoke the word of the Lord to him and to all the others in his house. [33] At that hour of the night the jailer took them and washed their wounds; then

immediately he and all his household were baptized. [34] The jailer brought them into his house and set a meal before them; he was filled with joy because he had come to believe in God—he and his whole household.

Holy Gospel

John 3: 16-21

[16] For God so loved the world that he gave his one and only Son, that whoever believes in him shall not perish but have eternal life. [17] For God did not send his Son into the world to condemn the world, but to save the world through him. [18] Whoever believes in him is not condemned, but whoever does not believe stands condemned already because they have not believed in the name of God's one and only Son. [19] This is the verdict: Light has come into the world, but people loved darkness instead of light because their deeds were evil. [20] Everyone who does evil hates the light, and will not come into the light for fear that their deeds will be exposed. [21] But whoever lives by the truth comes into the light, so that it may be seen plainly that what they have done has been done in the sight of God.

Apostle's Creed

I believe in God, the Father Almighty, Maker of heaven and earth.

And in Jesus Christ, his only Son, our Lord, who was conceived by the Holy Spirit, born of the virgin Mary, Suffered under Pontius Pilate, was crucified, died and was buried. He descended into hell. The third day he rose again from the dead. He ascended into heaven and sits at the right hand of God the Father almighty. From thence he will come to judge the living and the dead.

I believe in the Holy Spirit, the holy Christian Church, the communion of saints, the forgiveness of sins, the resurrection of the body, and the life everlasting. Amen.

Hymn ***“Lord of All Hopefulness” # 738***



1 Lord of all hope - ful - ness, Lord of all joy,
2 Lord of all ea - ger - ness, Lord of all faith,
3 Lord of all kind - li - ness, Lord of all grace,
4 Lord of all gen - tle - ness, Lord of all calm,



Whose trust, ev - er child - like, no cares could de - stroy:
Whose strong hands were skilled at the plane and the lathe:
Your hands swift to wel - come, Your arms to em - brace:
Whose voice is con - tent - ment, whose pres - ence is balm:



Be there at our wak - ing, and give us, we pray,
Be there at our la - bors, and give us, we pray,
Be there at our hom - ing, and give us, we pray,
Be there at our sleep - ing, and give us, we pray,



Your bliss in our hearts, Lord, at the break of the day.
Your strength in our hearts, Lord, at the noon of the day.
Your love in our hearts, Lord, at the eve of the day.
Your peace in our hearts, Lord, at the end of the day.

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Message

Offering

The Prayers and Lord’s Prayer

Order of Holy Communion

P If, when you are bringing your gift to the altar, you suddenly remember that your brother has a grievance against you, leave your gift where it is before the altar. First go and make peace with your brother, and only then come back and offer your gift. Let us share that peace with one another.

The sharing of peace

- P** Lift up your hearts.
- C** **We lift them up to the Lord.**
- P** Let us give thanks for his glory.
- C** **We give thanks; we rejoice in his presence.**
- P** Thanks and praise be to you, O Father, who sent your only Son into the world to be a man, born of a woman, to die for us on a cross that was made by us.
- C** **He came for us. Help us to accept his coming.**
- P** He walked among us, a man, on our earth, in our world of conflict, and commanded us to remember his death, his death which gives us life; and to wait for him until he comes again in glory.
- C** **We remember his death; we live by his presence; we wait for his coming.**

The Words of Institution

- P** The gifts of God for the people of God.
- C** **Amen.**

The Distribution

The Post-communion Prayer

- P** We give thanks to You, loving and faithful Lord, for by the ransom payment You have made with Your truly precious blood You have provided for our healing. You have restored us that we may now live in Your presence eternally. We rejoice that as a result of our

participation in this Sacrament You are at work in us enabling us to live with the Spirit. Give us the hearts of servants and fulfill Your good purposes in our lives; through the same Jesus Christ, who lives and reigns with the Father and the Holy Spirit, now and forever.

C Amen.

Benediction

P The Lord bless you and keep you. The Lord make His face shine on you and be gracious to you. The Lord look upon you with favor and give you peace.

C Amen.

Closing Hymn ***“Now the Light Has Gone Away” # 887***



1 Now the light has gone a - way; Fa - ther, lis - ten while I pray,
2 Je - sus, Sav - ior, wash a - way All that has been wrong to - day;
3 Let my near and dear ones be Al - ways near and dear to Thee;
4 Now my eve-ning praise I give; Thou didst die that I might live.
5 Thou, my best and kind-est Friend, Thou wilt love me to the end.



Ask - ing Thee to watch and keep And to send me qui - et sleep.
Help me ev - 'ry day to be Good and gen - tle, more like Thee.
O bring me and all I love To Thy hap - py home a - bove.
All my bless-ings come from Thee; Oh, how good Thou art to me!
Let me love Thee more and more, Al - ways bet - ter than be - fore.

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Postlude

